

How We Operate (READ FIRST)

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Purpose: This page defines *how SEO is practiced at Webserv*

This is not a task list.

This is **how we think, act, and show up**.

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🔮 Our SEO Philosophy 🔮

What We Believe

- SEO is a **business growth channel**, not a traffic exercise
- Rankings are indicators — **admissions are the goal**
- Google rewards **clarity, credibility, and consistency**, not hacks
- Behavioral health SEO requires **higher trust, higher scrutiny, and higher standards**
- SEO, CRO, Technical, Local, and Content **cannot operate in silos**

What This Means in Practice

- We prioritize **impact over volume**
- We avoid tactics we wouldn't defend to Google or a client
- We build for **long-term equity**, not short-term wins
- We explain *why*, not just *what*

How Decisions Are Made

Decision Hierarchy

1. **Client business goals**
2. **Search intent & user need**

3. **Google quality & compliance standards**
4. **Historical performance data**
5. **SEO best practices**

👉 If a tactic violates any of the above, **we don't do it.**

Default Decision Principles

- When in doubt, **simplify**
 - When traffic is flat, **improve relevance before adding volume**
 - When conversions drop, **fix experience before creating content**
 - When volatility hits, **pause, diagnose, then act**
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Roles & Accountability

Clear Ownership

- **Director / AD:** Strategy quality, risk oversight, escalation
- **SEO AM:** Execution, client communication, performance monitoring
- **Cross-functional:** CRO, Paid, Dev alignment when needed

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What “Ownership” Means

- You don't just report problems — **you bring options**
 - You don't wait for perfect data — **you make informed calls**
 - You don't hide behind tools — **you interpret them** </aside>
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How We Work With Clients

Expectations We Set

- SEO is **iterative, not instant**
- Not every month looks the same

- Short-term volatility ≠ long-term failure
- Transparency > false certainty

How We Communicate

- Clear, calm, and confident
- No jargon without explanation
- No panic during algorithm updates
- No overpromising — ever

Our Client Red Lines

- No deceptive claims
 - No unethical tactics
 - No pressure to “game” Google
 - No shortcuts that risk YMYL trust
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Quality Standards (Non-Negotiables)

Every SEO Initiative Must:

- Align with **search intent**
- Meet **EEAT expectations**
- Be defensible to SEO Leadership
- Be defensible in a Google review
- Be explainable to a client
- Be measurable beyond rankings

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If It Doesn't Meet These: It doesn't ship.

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How We Handle Change & Volatility

Algorithm Updates

- We **observe before reacting**
- We diagnose with data, not fear
- We communicate early and calmly
- We document learnings for future use

When Performance Drops

- We triage before pivoting
 - We isolate variables
 - We avoid mass changes without evidence
 - We escalate early when needed
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Documentation Is Part of the Job

If it isn't documented:

- It didn't happen
- It can't be improved
- It can't be scaled

Expectations

- Strategies are documented
 - Decisions are logged
 - Learnings are shared
 - SOPs are followed *or intentionally broken with reason*
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How We Improve as a Team

Continuous Improvement

- We review wins *and* failures

- We share what worked — and what didn't
- We update SOPs as Google evolves
- We challenge assumptions respectfully

Psychological Safety

- Questions are encouraged
 - Escalation is a strength, not a weakness
 - Quality > ego
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What Success Looks Like

Success is not:

- Rankings alone
- Traffic spikes without leads
- Busy work
- “Because that’s how it’s always been done”

Success is:

- Consistent lead (admits) growth
 - Defensible strategies
 - Clients who trust our guidance
 - A team that understands *why* they do what they do
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Final Reminder

This HQ exists to:

- Protect quality
- Reduce chaos
- Enable scale
- Build trust — internally and externally

